Central Mine Planning & Design Institute Ltd.

Rating	Issue Opens On	Issue Closes On	Listing Date	Price Band (INR)	Issue Size (INR Mn)
Not Rated	March 20, 2026	March 24, 2026	March 30, 2026	163 - 172	1,84,212

About Company - Central Mine Planning & Design Institute Limited (CMPDIL) was incorporated on November 1, 1975, as a wholly owned subsidiary of Coal India Limited. It is a multidisciplinary organization and a leading player in the Indian mining consultancy sector, commanding a 61.0% market share in Fiscal 2025 and holding Mini Ratna (Category I) status. CMPDIL provides a comprehensive suite of consultancy and support services spanning the entire mining lifecycle, from initial geological exploration and resource evaluation to mine planning, environmental management, geomatics, and mine closure.

Outlook - India's mining consultancy sector today sits at an inflection point., driven by a combination of rising energy demand, aggressive coal production targets, and a strategic push toward critical minerals. The industry, though niche, is structurally expanding, supported by policy-led initiatives such as the 1.5 BT coal production roadmap, commercial mining auctions, and the National Critical Minerals Mission. This has created a multi-year pipeline of exploration, mine planning, and environmental consultancy work, making mining services a critical enabler of India's broader industrial and energy ambitions. At the center of this ecosystem is CMPDIL, with 61% market share and deep integration with Coal India. Its end-to-end capabilities, regulatory accreditations, and decades of data give it a dominant position in coal consultancy, while its growing presence in non-CIL and private sector projects reflects early diversification.
Looking ahead, near-term growth remains anchored in coal expansion, while critical minerals and technology-led services offer long-term optionality. CIL's 787MT capacity augmentation drive through 50 new mines, combined with 136 commercially auctioned coal blocks requiring end-to-end consultancy, provides structural multi-year revenue visibility across all four business verticals. Despite risks around client concentration and energy transition, CMPDIL is evolving into a broader mining infrastructure play, with strong earnings visibility and re-rating potential.

Valuation - The company has delivered 23% revenue CAGR and 48%+ Operating EBITDA CAGR over FY23–FY25, with RoCE at 49%, reflecting strong operating leverage on a zero-debt, capital-light consultancy model. The addressable mining consultancy market is estimated at INR 34,252Mn in FY25 and projected to grow at 4.8% CAGR to INR 43,274Mn by FY30, with CMPDI commanding a dominant 61% market share. The company's increasing diversification into rare earth and critical mineral exploration, underpinned by the National Critical Minerals Mission (INR 16,349Cr allocation) and NMET funding that has scaled from INR 800Mn (FY18) to INR 11,140Mn (FY25), provides significant incremental growth optionality beyond the core coal consultancy franchise. With ongoing NMET-funded projects in magnetite (Jharkhand) and graphite (Madhya Pradesh), and 81.88MT of bauxite resources already established, CMPDI is positioning itself as the go-to exploration partner for India's critical mineral self-reliance push across bauxite, manganese, copper, lithium and rare earth elements.

Peer listed consultancies trade at 19.9–25.2x FY25 P/E (EIL and RITES), albeit with significantly inferior return profiles (RoE 15–24% vs. CMPDI's 37%, PAT margins 18% vs. 31%). The company is currently trading at 21x FY26E, with stable growth through coal and other minerals. Given the current geopolitical situation we expect coal to remain in focus in near term & therefore CMPDIL monopolistic market position, superior capital efficiency, and may potentially lead to premium multiples to other consultancy peers making the timing of IPO very ideal & lucky for company.

Key Risks - CMPDIL faces high client concentration, with Coal India Limited and its top 10 clients accounting for over 93% of revenue. Heavy reliance on government funding and projects creates vulnerability to policy shifts. Exploration failure, technological obsolescence, and the emergence of renewable energy further threaten long-term profitability

Offer Details

Particulars	IPO Details
No. of shares under IPO (Mn)	107.1
Fresh issue (# shares) (Mn)	-
Offer for sale (# shares) (Mn)	107.1
Price band (INR)	163 – 172
Post issue MCAP (INR Mn)	116,000 – 123,000

Source: IPO Prospectus

Issue	# Shares (Mn)	INR Mn	%
QIB	53.55	9,211	Not more than 50%
Retail	37.49	6,448	Not less than 35%
NII	16.07	2,764	Not less than 15%

Source: IPO Prospectus

Shareholding Pattern	Pre-Issue (%)	Post-Issue (%)
Promoters & Promoters Group (Coal India)	100	85
Others	0	15
Total	**100%**	**100%**

Source: IPO Prospectus

Objects of the Offer	INR Mn
Offer For Sale (Coal India – 100%)	**1,84,212**

BRLM
IDBI Capital Markets Services Ltd.
SBI Capital Markets Ltd.

Indicative Timetable	
Offer Closing Date	24 March 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with Stock Exchange	25 March 2026
Initiation of Refunds	27 March 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to Demat accounts	27 March 2026
Commencement of Trading of Eq. shares on NSE	30 March 2026

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Central Mine Planning & Design Institute Ltd.

Company Overview

Central Mine Planning & Design Institute Limited (CMPDIL) is India's largest coal and mineral consultancy company, commanding a 61% market share (FY25) in the Indian mining consultancy sector. Established in 1975 as a wholly-owned subsidiary of Coal India Limited (CIL), the world's largest coal producer, CMPDIL provides end-to-end consultancy and technical services spanning the entire mining lifecycle, from initial geological exploration to mine closure.

The company serves as the preferred consulting partner for Coal India Limited and functions as a strategic advisor to the Ministry of Coal, Government of India. CMPDIL is the dedicated custodian of India's national coal and lignite database, maintaining comprehensive inventories of coal deposits, mining potentials, and operations. It also serves as the nodal agency for Government of India schemes funded by the Ministry of Coal, including science & technology projects, exploration work in non-CIL blocks, and CIL R&D Board projects.

With nearly 50 years of operational history, CMPDIL has published over 320 project reports in the last decade, executed over 700 geological exploration reports, and prepared over 300 hydrogeological reports since April 2021. The company operates through its headquarters in Ranchi and seven regional institutes co-located with CIL subsidiaries across key coal-producing states (West Bengal, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, and Odisha), supported by eight well-equipped laboratories and one of the largest fleets of exploratory drills for coal and minerals in India (58 departmental drills as of December 2025).

CMPDIL is actively diversifying beyond coal into critical minerals exploration (lithium, rare earth elements, bauxite, copper, graphite), renewable energy consulting (solar power design for CIL), and clean coal technologies (Coal Bed Methane, Underground Coal Gasification). The company has expanded its client base from 38 clients (FY23) to 76 clients (December 2025), with non-CIL revenue growing from 17.3% to 34.0% of total revenue during this period.
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Business Verticals

Vertical	Revenue FY25 (Rs Cr)	% Mix	Description
Geological Exploration & Resource Evaluation	970.8	46.2%	Core competency since inception. Includes drilling (1.0 Mn meters achieved in FY25), geological mapping, 2D/3D seismic surveys, geophysical logging, hydrogeological studies, resource modelling (Minex, Vulcan software), and geological report preparation. Completed 31 geological reports in FY25.
Mine Planning & Design Services	445.3	21.2%	Open-pit and underground mine planning, feasibility studies, technology selection, production scheduling, infrastructure engineering, coal washing consultancy, First Mile Connectivity projects. Planned mines up to 85 MTPA capacity and 420m depth. Submitted 33 project reports in FY25.
Environment Services	359.7	17.1%	Environmental Impact Assessments (EIA), Environment Management Plans (EMP), mine closure planning, carbon footprint analysis, ecological studies, environmental monitoring via NABL-accredited labs. Prepared 48 EIA/EMP reports in FY25. NABET-accredited EIA consultant.
Geomatics & Survey Services	326.9	15.5%	Satellite remote sensing, GIS, GPS, digital photogrammetry, LiDAR, drone surveys, gyroscope-based underground surveys, overburden volumetric measurement, coal stock measurement, land use mapping.
Other Services (R&D, Clean Energy, IT, Training)	Included above	-	5G Use Case Lab, CBM/UCG development, solar power design, AI-enabled mine safety, software portals for CIL/MoC, ISO management system consultancy, HRD training programs.

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

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Competitive Moats

Regulatory Accreditations:

CMPDIL's competitive moat is both deep and multi-layered, anchored in a combination of regulatory, data, institutional, and scale advantages that are difficult to replicate. At the forefront are regulatory accreditations, such as NABET-certified mine planning and EIA capabilities, which are limited in number and take years to obtain and maintain creating significant entry barriers.

Data Custody:

This is reinforced by CMPDIL's proprietary data custody, built over 50+ years of geological exploration across India's coalfields. This vast repository of coal and hydrogeological data is not commercially replicable and provides a structural edge in accuracy and execution. Alongside this, the company benefits from strong institutional trust and PSU backing, with a long-standing relationship with the Ministry of Coal and Coal India, enhancing credibility and ensuring steady work inflows.

Switching Cost:

High switching costs further strengthen the moat, as replicating CMPDIL's integrated capabilities ranging from data to drilling infrastructure and skilled workforce would require over a decade. Additionally, scale advantages and a concentrated market structure enable superior operating efficiency. Over time, each project adds to CMPDIL's data pool, creating a reinforcing feedback loop that continuously strengthens its competitive positioning.

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Drill Fleet & Physical Infrastructure:

CMPDIL's large, owned drilling fleet and nationwide infrastructure create a scale advantage that is difficult and time-consuming to replicate. While capital can build assets, achieving similar operational depth and integration remains a strong barrier..

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

Institutional Trust & Credibility

CMPDIL's institutional trust and credibility form a powerful and enduring moat built over decades of close engagement with the Ministry of Coal and other government bodies. Its role goes beyond execution, extending into policy advisory and strategic support, positioning it as a trusted partner rather than just a consultancy provider. The company's work has been referenced in regulatory and judicial contexts, reinforcing its authority and reliability. In an industry where compliance, track record, and trust are critical, such long-standing relationships provide a significant competitive advantage. This deep-rooted credibility is difficult for new entrants both domestic and global to replicate, making it a key differentiator in sustaining CMPDIL's market leadership.

Workforce & Technical Expertise

CMPDIL's human capital forms a critical competitive moat, built over decades of domain specialization in geology, mining engineering, and environmental sciences. The company has developed a deeply experienced workforce capable of handling complex, large-scale projects across the entire mining lifecycle. This expertise is not easily transferable or scalable in the short term, given the niche skill sets and on-ground experience required. Additionally, training and developing such talent requires long gestation periods and access to a mature ecosystem, which new entrants often lack

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Key Risks

Revenue Concentration

CMPDIL's high dependence on Coal India Limited (CIL) remains its most critical structural risk, with 66% of revenues in 9M FY26 derived from CIL and its subsidiaries. This exposes the company to fluctuations in CIL's capex cycle, procurement policies, and operational performance. Any shift from nomination-based contracts to competitive bidding, delays in mine development, or execution challenges at CIL could directly impact CMPDIL's order inflows and revenue visibility. However, the trend is improving as CMPDIL actively diversifies its revenue base. Non-CIL revenues have grown significantly, from INR 2,400 Mn in FY23 to INR 6,921 Mn in FY25, raising their share from 17.3% to 34.0%. Importantly, this diversification is additive, with CIL revenues still growing in absolute terms. The company's expanding client base, particularly in commercial coal mining and non-coal segments, provides incremental growth avenues.

Metric	FY23	FY24	FY25	9M FY26	Trend
Revenue from CIL & Subsidiaries (Rs Mn)	11,461	13,903	14,107	9,833	Growing in absolute terms
CIL Share of Total Revenue	82.7%	80.2%	67.1%	66.0%	DECLINING share
Non-CIL Revenue (Rs Mn)	2,400	3,424	6,921	5,064	Tripled in 2 years
Non-CIL Share of Revenue	17.3%	19.8%	32.9%	34.0%	Rapidly Increasing

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

Working Capital Risk

CMPDIL faces a moderate working capital risk arising from delays in receivables from Coal India subsidiaries, which has been consistently highlighted by auditors as an emphasis of matter. As of December 31, 2025, outstanding dues exceeding one year stood at INR 99.23 crore, increasing from INR 72.03 crore in FY25 and INR 65.71 crore in FY24, indicating a rising trend in delayed collections. This is despite an existing CIL circular mandating 75% payment within 15 days of bill submission, suggesting a gap between policy and actual execution. The persistence of this issue across multiple reporting periods highlights structural inefficiencies in payment cycles within the CIL ecosystem. Prolonged receivables can impact CMPDIL's cash flow visibility and working capital efficiency, especially given its continued reliance on CIL-linked revenues. However, the risk is partially mitigated by the sovereign backing of CIL, which reduces counterparty default risk, and CMPDIL's asset-light, high-margin business model that limits balance sheet stress. Overall, while this remains a recurring operational concern, it is more of a liquidity timing issue rather than a credit risk, and is unlikely to materially impair long-term financial stability.

Energy Transition

The most significant structural headwind stems from the global and domestic energy transition. India's commitments at COP26—targeting 500 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2030 and achieving net-zero emissions by 2070, clearly signal a policy-backed shift away from coal over the long term. While coal will remain indispensable in the near to medium term, particularly for baseload power, the demand curve is expected to peak around FY30–35. Beyond this point, coal production growth is likely to plateau, leading to a gradual moderation in the total addressable market (TAM) for coal consultancy services. This introduces a long-duration risk of revenue stagnation unless offset by diversification into non-coal minerals and adjacent verticals.

Regulatory Complexity

From an operational standpoint, regulatory bottlenecks remain a persistent challenge. Mining projects in India are subject to multiple layers of approvals, including Environmental Clearance (EC), Forest Clearance (FC), permissions from the Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA), and State Pollution Control Boards. Delays in forest clearances, in particular, have been highlighted as a key industry concern, often slowing down exploration and project execution timelines. However, this very complexity acts as a double-edged sword, it creates execution risks but also reinforces entry barriers, favoring incumbents like CMPDIL that have decades of experience navigating these processes.

Overall, while CMPDIL operates in a structurally favorable industry today, these disruption vectors highlight the importance of strategic diversification, technological adoption, and continued institutional relevance. The company's ability to transition from a coal-centric model to a broader mineral and technology-enabled consultancy platform will be critical in sustaining long-term growth amid an evolving macro landscape.

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About Management

Chaudhari Shivraj Singh
Chairman - cum - Managing Director

Mr. Chaudhari, brings over 35 years of experience in the mining sector, providing strategic direction and industry leadership.

Nripendra Nath
Director (Technical/ Research, Development & Technology) and Director (Technical/ Coal Resource Development)

Mr. Nripendra Nath, with over 37 years of experience, leads innovation and resource development initiatives.

Rajeev Kumar Sinha
Director (Technical/ Engineering Services)

Mr. Rajeev Kumar Sinha with ~35 years of experience, drives core mine planning and execution capabilities.

Ajay Kumar
Director (Technical/ Planning & Design)

Mr. Ajay Kumar brings over 35 years of extensive experience in the mining sector, with deep expertise in mine planning, design, and project execution. He plays a critical role in overseeing CMPDIL's core technical functions

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Competitive Landscape

The Indian mining consultancy industry is highly concentrated, with CMPDIL firmly at its center. As of FY25, the company alone commands 61% market share, while the top three players, CMPDIL, MECL, and MECON—collectively control nearly 75–80% of the addressable market. This concentration underscores a clear dominance, with limited competitive fragmentation.

What further strengthens CMPDIL's position is not just scale, but superior financial quality. The company stands out as the most profitable mining consultancy in India, delivering 40% operating EBITDA margins and 37% ROAE, well above typical PSU consultancy benchmarks. Coupled with a zero-debt balance sheet and a consistent dividend track record, CMPDIL combines market leadership with high-quality, sustainable earnings.

Metric	CMPDIL	RITES	EIL	MECL	MECON
Revenue FY25 (Rs Mn)	21,028	22,178	30,876	3,706	11,495
Revenue CAGR FY23-25	23.2%	-8.1%	-3.7%	32.1%	13.7%
Opr EBITDA Margin FY25	40.0%	23.8%	16.6%	23.1%	-3.2%
PAT FY25 (Rs Mn)	6,669	4,237	5,798	818	290
PAT Margin FY25	30.6%	18.0%	17.9%	20.2%	2.5%
ROAE FY25	36.7%	15.0%	24.0%	11.0%	7.0%
RoACE FY25	48.6%	21.0%	26.0%	17.0%	11.0%
Total Borrowings	NIL	NIL	NIL	N/A	N/A

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

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Industry Overview

India's mining consultancy industry is evolving into a structurally important enabler of the country's resource security and industrial growth. At the center of this ecosystem is CMPDIL, operating in a niche yet critical segment that provides end-to-end technical, engineering, and advisory solutions across the entire mineral lifecycle, from geological exploration and resource estimation to mine planning, regulatory compliance, environmental management, and operational optimization.

The industry itself remains relatively concentrated but steadily expanding. Valued at INR 3,425 crore in FY25, the Indian mining consultancy market is projected to grow to INR 4,327 crore by FY30, implying a modest yet stable CAGR of 4.8%. Within this landscape, CMPDIL stands as the undisputed leader, commanding a dominant ~61% market share, significantly ahead of peers, reflecting both its legacy strength and deep integration with India's coal ecosystem.

From a lifecycle perspective, the industry is currently in a dual-phase evolution. The coal consultancy segment is in a **growth phase**, supported by India's aggressive push toward 1,500 MMT coal production, which is driving sustained demand for exploration, mine development, and planning services. However, this segment is structurally closer to peaking, with expectations of entering a **maturity phase by FY30–35** as coal demand stabilizes and eventually begins to decline in line with energy transition trends.

In contrast, the non-coal and critical minerals consultancy segment is at a much earlier stage, transitioning from **nascent to early growth**. This is being catalyzed by policy initiatives such as the National Critical Minerals Mission and the acceleration of commercial mining auctions, which are unlocking a new wave of exploration and development opportunities across minerals like lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earths.

This divergence creates a clear strategic inflection point. While coal continues to anchor near-term revenues and visibility, the long-term growth vector lies in critical minerals. CMPDIL's ongoing diversification into non-coal consultancy is therefore not just an expansion strategy, but a necessary pivot to align with the next multi-decade opportunity in India's mining landscape, positioning it to sustain relevance even as the traditional coal cycle matures.

TAM Breakdown

Segment	FY25 (Rs Mn)	FY30P (Rs Mn)	5Y CAGR	CMPDIL FY25 Revenue	CMPDIL Share
Planning & Design	8,400	10,613	4.8%	4,453 (21.2%)	~53%
Exploration	16,196	20,462	4.8%	9,708 (46.2%)	~60%
Geomatics	4,772	6,029	4.8%	3,269 (15.5%)	~69%
Environment	4,884	6,170	4.8%	3,597 (17.1%)	~74%
TOTAL	**34,252**	**43,274**	**4.8%**	**21,028 (100%)**	**61.0%**

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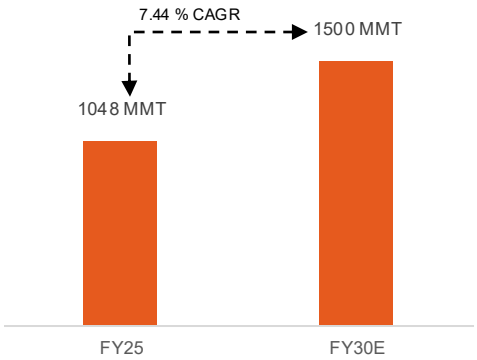
Themes Shaping the Industry

Theme 1: Coal Production Acceleration Toward 1.5 BT:

India's push to scale coal production to 1,500 MMT by FY30—implying a 42% increase over FY25—marks the foundation of a strong, visibility-backed growth cycle for mining consultancy. With Coal India planning 50 new/expanded mines adding 787 MT capacity, the requirement for exploration, mine planning, EIA, and environmental monitoring becomes structurally embedded. This creates a multi-year execution pipeline, where CMPDIL, given its 61% market share and direct linkage with CIL, stands as the primary beneficiary of this large-scale capacity expansion.



Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

Theme 2: Critical Minerals Exploration - The Next Growth Frontier

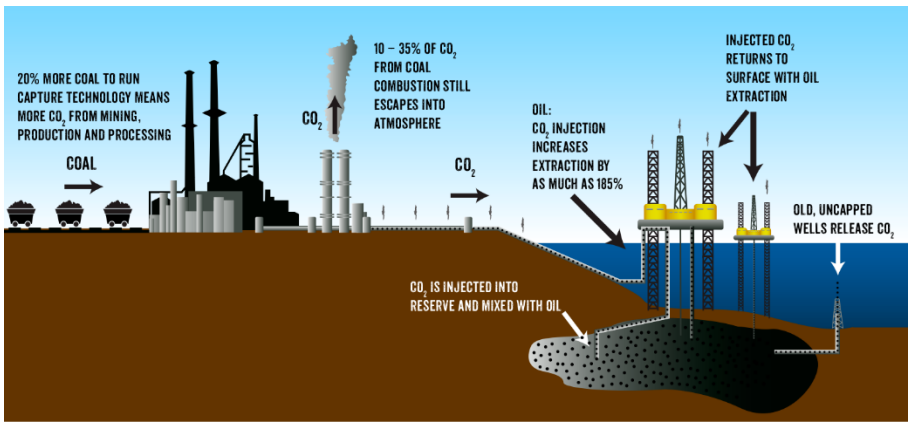
While coal anchors the present, critical minerals define the future. India's near 100% import dependence on lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earths has triggered a policy-led shift through the National Critical Minerals Mission (2025), supported by INR 16,349 crore allocation and 1,200 exploration projects. With multiple mineral blocks already auctioned and Coal India entering global lithium exploration, this marks a structural pivot in India's resource strategy. For CMPDIL, this extends its relevance well beyond the coal cycle. Early wins in non-coal projects and strong adjacency in capabilities, combined with PSU-backed access to government programs, position it favorably to capture this long-duration opportunity.

Theme 3: Commercialization of Coal Sector & Private Sector Entry

The opening up of the coal sector to private players has created a parallel demand engine. With 136 coal blocks auctioned and production from commercial mines expected to scale sharply by FY30, the need for technical consultancy is rising. A large portion of these blocks remains under-explored, requiring significant drilling and planning before operationalization. Given that many private players lack in-house expertise, dependence on established consultants like CMPDIL is increasing. This is reflected in its expanding client base and rising non-CIL revenue contribution, indicating a gradual but strategic diversification.

Theme 4: Clean Coal Technologies & Alternative Uses of Coal

Beyond traditional mining, the focus is shifting toward unlocking deeper and unconventional coal resources. Technologies such as underground coal gasification (UCG), coal gasification, and coal bed methane (CBM) are extending the usable life of coal reserves while reducing import dependence on hydrocarbons. CMPDIL's involvement in pilot projects and its role in CBM initiatives position it at the forefront of these emerging applications. These areas open up new consultancy verticals ranging from feasibility studies to reservoir modeling, adding incremental revenue streams beyond conventional services.



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Key Regulations Governing the Industry

Regulation / Policy	Year	Impact on CMPDIL
MMDR Act, 1957 (amended 2015, 2020, 2023)	1957+	Cornerstone of mining regulation. 2015 amendments introduced auction-based allocation. 2020 amendments opened coal to commercial mining. 2023 amendments introduced Exploration License for critical minerals. Each amendment has expanded CMPDIL's addressable market.
CMSP Act, 2015	2015	Enabled coal block auctions for end-users and commercial miners. 13 rounds of auctions completed, 136 blocks allocated. Created large consultancy demand for mine dossier preparation, exploration upgradation.
National Mineral Policy, 2019	2019	Promotes sustainable mining, technology adoption, and value addition. Supports CMPDIL's diversification into non-coal minerals.
Mineral Auction Rules, 2015	2015	Governs transparent bidding for mining leases and composite licenses. Each auctioned block requires exploration reports, mine plans, and EIA - all CMPDIL service areas.
Environment Protection Act, 1986 & EIA Notification	1986/ 2006	Mandates Environmental Impact Assessments for all major mining projects. CMPDIL is one of 219 NABET-accredited EIA consultants. Regulatory compliance creates recurring demand.
Forest Conservation Act, 1980	1980	Mining in forested areas requires Forest Clearance. Adds complexity and consultancy demand for environmental services.
SHAKTI Policy, 2017	2017	Coal linkage allocation policy for power plants. Drives coal demand predictability, supporting CIL's production targets and CMPDIL's consultancy pipeline.
National Critical Minerals Mission, 2025	2025	Rs 16,349 Cr mission for self-reliance in critical minerals. Directly creates exploration demand for lithium, REE, cobalt, nickel, graphite. CMPDIL is well-positioned as PSU exploration agency.
Mission Coking Coal, 2021	2021	Targets 140 MT domestic raw coking coal by FY30. Requires new mine development, washery modernization - all CMPDIL service areas.
Mine Closure Plan Requirements	Ongoing	All mines must have approved closure plans. Creates recurring consultancy demand across mine lifecycle.

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

The policy and regulatory environment in India is increasingly acting as a strong catalyst for mining consultancy demand, creating multiple parallel growth levers for players like CMPDIL. A key structural shift is the introduction of **Exploration License (EL) auctions under the 2023 MMDR Amendment**, with 13 blocks already put up for auction. This marks the creation of a new exploration-led demand segment, expanding the scope of consultancy services beyond traditional mining support.

Simultaneously, the government's **Abandoned Coal Block Auction Policy** is bringing previously closed mines back into the ecosystem through private participation. These assets require fresh geological evaluation, mine planning, and feasibility assessments—directly translating into incremental consultancy opportunities. In parallel, the approval of the **Underground Coal Gasification (UCG) policy framework** is opening up access to deeper, uneconomical reserves, with CMPDIL already executing a pilot project—potentially creating an entirely new vertical upon commercialization.

Regulatory compliance is also becoming more stringent. SEBI's **BRSR framework** mandates ESG disclosures, increasing demand for environmental and sustainability consultancy across mining operations. On the funding side, a sharp increase in **NMEDT utilization from INR 831 million in FY21 to INR 11,140 million in FY25 **has significantly strengthened the exploration pipeline, with CMPDIL as a key beneficiary.

Further, **100% FDI in coal mining** is enabling global players to enter India, many of whom rely on domestic consultants for execution. Coupled with continued government allocations (INR 7,500 million in FY26) and India's strategic plan to build 1.8–2.5 billion tonnes of coal stock, these policies collectively front-load exploration and mining activity creating a sustained and policy-backed demand environment for consultancy services.

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Structural Drivers:

India's mining and exploration landscape is entering a structurally strong upcycle, underpinned by a dual engine of rising energy demand and strategic mineral security. Coal demand is expected to grow at a steady 3.7% CAGR over FY25–FY30E, driven by power demand expanding at 7.0% CAGR to 2,378 BU by FY30, with coal continuing to anchor 73% of electricity generation. This structural reliance necessitates a sharp ramp-up in domestic coal production to 1,500 MMT by FY30, translating into significant upstream activity, including development of ~50 new mines by Coal India alone, thereby accelerating requirements for exploration, drilling, mine planning, and environmental clearances.

Parallelly, India is building a future-facing mineral ecosystem. The National Critical Minerals Mission (2025) unlocks a INR 16,349+Cr opportunity across lithium, rare earths, cobalt, nickel, and graphite, with the Geological Survey of India planning 1,200exploration projects between FY25–FY31. Commercial coal mining is also gaining traction, with 136 blocks already auctioned (53 partly explored), creating a visible and multi-year drilling pipeline. Estimated drilling demand from commercial coal blocks alone is projected at 9.3 lakh meters in FY26, sustaining at healthy levels through FY30.

Adding to this momentum, India's steel capacity target of 300 MT by FY31 and the Mission Coking Coal initiative (targeting 140MT domestic raw coking coal by FY30) further reinforce the long-term demand for exploration and mining services. Collectively, these drivers create a strong, policy-backed and execution-visible growth runway for companies operating across mining services, drilling, and exploration value chains.

Catalysts:

While the long-term outlook for India's mining and exploration sector remains structurally strong, the near- to medium-term trajectory is meaningfully shaped by a set of cyclical drivers that influence execution intensity and budget flows.

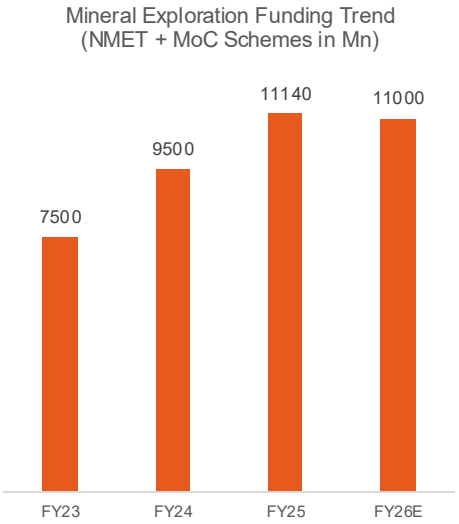
At the core, coal price cycles play a pivotal role in determining the spending appetite of key incumbents like Coal India. Periods of elevated e-auction coal prices typically expand profitability, enabling higher internal accruals and, consequently, larger capex allocations toward mine development, exploration, and consultancy services. Conversely, any softness in coal prices can compress margins and lead to deferment or rationalization of exploration programs, directly impacting order flows for service providers.

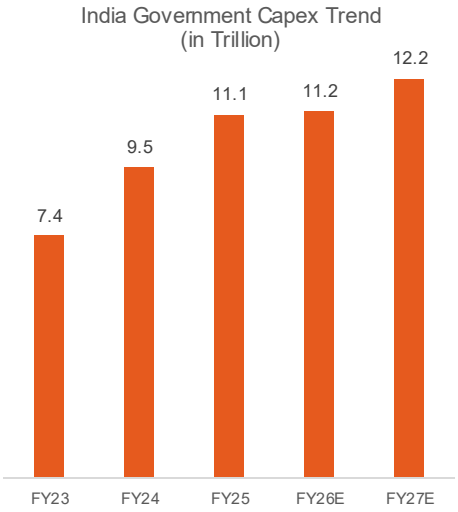
Overlaying this is the broader government capex cycle, which acts as a demand-side catalyst. Strong infrastructure spending—such as the record ₹12.2 lakh crore allocation for FY27—drives end-use demand across steel, cement, and power, thereby indirectly sustaining mining activity. However, this momentum remains contingent on fiscal priorities, and any shift toward consolidation in subsequent years could moderate the pace of project awarding and execution.

Global energy dynamics further introduce an external cyclical lever. Disruptions such as the Russia-Ukraine conflict or tensions involving key oil-producing regions have historically tightened global energy supply, raising imported coal prices and incentivizing higher domestic production. This substitution effect tends to accelerate mining activity during such periods, although it remains inherently event-driven and volatile.

Lastly, funding visibility for exploration is partially linked to government budget allocations under schemes like the National Mineral Exploration Trust and allied programs. While FY25 allocations stood at ₹11,140 million (including Ministry of Coal initiatives), these outlays are subject to annual budgetary decisions, creating a degree of unpredictability in exploration spending cycles.

Together, these factors create a cyclical overlay on an otherwise structurally growing sector, influencing the timing, scale, and consistency of opportunity realization for industry participants.





Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

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PORTER'S ANALYSIS

The Indian mining consultancy industry, when viewed through the lens of **Porter's Five Forces**, presents a structure that is distinctly favorable for incumbents, with CMPDIL occupying a position of structural dominance.

- The **threat of new entrants remains low**, primarily due to significant regulatory and operational barriers. Entry into this space requires NABET accreditation, deep technical expertise, and access to extensive geological datasets—assets that are built over decades, not years. CMPDIL's legacy advantages, including custody of over 50 years of coal data and ownership of a large drilling fleet, create formidable entry barriers. Its PSU status further strengthens this moat by enabling nomination-based work from Coal India, effectively limiting contestability in core coal consultancy.

- The **bargaining power of buyers is moderate**, shaped largely by the dominance of Coal India, which contributes a substantial portion of revenues and possesses monopsony-like characteristics. This concentration gives buyers some influence over pricing and contract structures. However, CMPDIL's gradual diversification into non-CIL segments and the limited availability of credible alternatives for large-scale mining consultancy dilute this power to an extent, particularly for private commercial mining players.

- On the supply side, the **bargaining power of suppliers is low**. The industry relies primarily on skilled geologists and engineers, along with owned drilling infrastructure, rather than critical third-party vendors. With limited dependency on external suppliers and relatively stable PSU-linked compensation structures, input-side risks remain contained, and cost structures are largely predictable.

- The **threat of substitutes is very low**, as mining consultancy services are not discretionary but embedded within regulatory frameworks. Activities such as environmental impact assessments, mine planning, and exploration approvals are mandatory for project execution. While digital technologies and AI tools may enhance productivity, they do not replace the need for core geological and engineering expertise, thereby preserving the indispensability of these services.

- Finally, **competitive rivalry is low to moderate**. Although players like MECL, MECON, and select private and international consultants operate in the space, the market is not driven by pricing aggression but by credibility, accreditations, and institutional relationships. CMPDIL's ~61% market share reflects its overwhelming dominance, particularly in coal consultancy, where competition is structurally limited.

Taken together, these forces indicate an industry structure that is **highly favorable for CMPDIL**, with strong entry barriers, limited substitution risk, and manageable competitive intensity. While rivalry is expected to increase in the non-coal and critical minerals segment with the entry of private and global players, CMPDIL's brand strength, government linkages, and first-mover advantage position it well to sustain leadership even as the industry evolves.

Force	Intensity	Key Evidence
Threat of New Entrants	LOW	NABET accreditation required for mine plan preparation and EIA consulting. Only 14 accredited MPPAs exist in India. CMPDIL's 50 years of coal data custody, 700+ geological reports, and one of India's largest drill fleets create insurmountable barriers. PSU status provides nomination-basis assignments from CIL.
Bargaining Power of Buyers	MEDIUM	CIL (67% of revenue) has monopsony-like power and can dictate pricing through nomination-basis contracts. However, CMPDIL is expanding non-CIL revenue (33% in FY25 vs 17% in FY23), reducing concentration. Private commercial coal block operators have fewer alternatives.
Bargaining Power of Suppliers	LOW	Key inputs are skilled geologists/engineers (PSU salary scales, limited attrition) and drill equipment (owned fleet). No critical third-party supplier dependency. Employee costs are the dominant cost item.
Threat of Substitutes	VERY LOW	Mining consultancy services are regulatory mandates (EIA, mine plan approval). No substitute for geological exploration drilling. Digital/AI tools augment but do not replace core services.
Competitive Rivalry	LOW-MEDIUM	CMPDIL has 61% market share. Nearest competitors are MECL (exploration, INR 3,706 Mn revenue FY25) and MECON (planning, INR 11,495 Mn revenue). Private players like DMT Consulting, SRK Consulting, Matrix Mining, Min Mec exist but are sub-scale. Market is not price-competitive; it is reputation and accreditation-competitive.

Source: Company Research, Deven Choksey Research

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Financials:

Income Statement (INR Mn)	FY23	FY24	FY25
Revenue	13,860.9	17,326.9	21,027.6
Operating Expenditure	10,031.3	10,057.4	12,618.2
EBITDA	3,829.6	7,269.5	8,409.4
EBITDA Margin %	27.63%	41.95%	39.99%
Other Income	126.9	374.9	747.7
Depreciation	286.1	315.4	334.8
Interest	0.9	0.6	0.9
PBT	3,669.5	7,328.4	8,821.4
Tax	702.9	2,296.1	2,152.3
PAT	2,966.6	5,032.3	6,669.1
PAT Margin (%)	21.40%	29.04%	31.72%
Adjusted EPS	4.2	7.0	9.3

Cash Flow (INR Mn)	FY23	FY24	FY25
CFFO	3994.1	(2299.2)	6711.4
CFFI	(1008.6)	(2299.2)	(4446.4)
CFFF	(942.1)	(1194.5)	(2012.2)
Net Increase/(Decrease) in Cash	2043.4	(1031.1)	252.8
Cash at beginning	**1527.6**	**3571.0**	**2539.9**
Cash at end	**3571.0**	**2539.9**	**2792.7**

Balance sheet (INR Mn)	FY23	FY24	FY25
Assets			
Non-Current Assets			
Property, plant and equipment	2,294.6	2,377.3	2,405.7
Other non-current assets	915.7	436.8	416.3
Total non-current assets	**3,210.3**	**2,814.1**	**2,822.0**
Current Assets			
Inventories	160.1	142.9	137.7
Trade receivables	8,224.0	9,843.7	9,436.8
Cash and cash equivalents	3,571.0	2,539.9	2,792.7
Other current assets	4,029.9	6,373.1	11,638.8
Total Current Assets	**15,985.0**	**18,899.6**	**24,006.0**
Assets classified as held for sale			
Total Assets	**19,195.3**	**21,713.7**	**26,828.0**
Equity & Liabilities			
Equity share capital	1,428.0	1,428.0	1,428.0
Equity component of compound financial instruments			
Reserves and surplus	10,748.5	14,488.1	18,990.5
Total Equity	**12,176.5**	**15,916.1**	**20,418.5**
Non -Current liabilities			
Financial liabilities	725.3	742.2	761.6
Other non-current liabilities	301.4	280.4	113.1
Total non-current liabilities	**1,026.7**	**1,022.6**	**874.7**
Current liabilities			
Financial liabilities	901.1	981.9	989.8
Trade payables	1,447.4	1,046.4	2,001.2
Other current liabilities	3,643.6	2,746.7	2,543.8
Total current liabilities	**5,992.1**	**4,775.0**	**5,534.8**
Liabilities directly associated with assets classified as held for sale			
Total liabilities	**7,018.8**	**5,797.6**	**6,409.5**
Total Equity and Liabilities	**19,195.3**	**21,713.7**	**26,828.0**

Source: IPO Prospectus, Deven Choksey Research

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